



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Palm Beach Christian Academy: North Stuart
School Website: <https://www.pbchristianacademy.org/north-stuart>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Palm Beach Christian Academy North Stuart (PBCA North Stuart) presents a predominantly classical profile across its public materials and campus messaging. The school foregrounds a Christ-centered, classical framework (Distinctively Christian; Distinctively Classical; Distinctively Community) and explicitly cites the Trivium (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric), great books, and Socratic dialogue as core elements of its pedagogy. Chapel, Scripture, and weekly worship surface as liturgical and communal practices, reinforcing a religious-metaphysical grounding. The public materials emphasize character formation, virtue, and biblical worldview alongside intellectual formation, aligning closely with classical aims of truth, goodness, and beauty in the learning process.

Across the six categories of the classical rubric, PBCA North Stuart demonstrates strength in Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, and to a solid extent in Pedagogy and Community. It shows partial alignment in Faculty, and robust alignment in Community. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL, with some opportunities to deepen explicit articulation of faculty as a living curriculum and to more fully document some pedagogical practices that solidify a fully "classical" profile across all six categories.

Executive findings by category (category-by-category snapshot follows) indicate:

- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): CLASSICAL
- Evidence of Scripture-centered, Christ-focused formation; weekly chapel and worship; theology-inflected language in mission statements.
- Positive keywords centered on Scripture, Christ-centeredness, worship, and biblical worldview; minimal to no alignment with negative framings in the school's public materials.
- Element 2 (Purpose and Goal): CLASSICAL
- Emphasis on virtue formation, character formation, and pursuit of truth within a biblical framework; formation over purely informational aims is consistently present.
- Element 3 (Curriculum): CLASSICAL
- Clear Trivium reference (grammar, logic, rhetoric), emphasis on Great Books / Great Conversation, and Socratic dialogue as core curricular methods; explicit intent to cultivate wonder and intellectual formation.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence of Socratic dialogue and rhetoric emphasis, plus contemplative/restful elements through worship, chapel, and memory-focused practices in lower grades. Some required high-school-level

Socratic pedagogy is implied but not always explicit across all grade levels in available public materials.

- Element 5 (Faculty): SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Public materials emphasize caring, mentorship, and a staff-community focus, with testimonials and “team” imagery. However, explicit language describing faculty as the “living curriculum” or as a core, shaping the school’s character in the exact classical sense is less evident in the materials reviewed.
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): CLASSICAL
- Strong emphasis on partnership with parents and community, including shared mission, co-ownership language, and visible family testimonials; explicit statements about parental co-education and visits are present.

Overall, PBCA North Stuart qualifies as CLASSICAL, with some categories showing more explicit classical alignment (Religious Foundations, Purpose, Curriculum, Community) and a couple showing partial alignment that would benefit from stronger articulation of the faculty role and broader, grade-spanning explicit pedagogy in the classical mold.

What follows is a detailed, category-by-category breakdown, followed by concrete needle-movers (for the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL categories) and an abstract summary.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials present a Distinctively Christian framing: Scripture-rooted learning, Christ at the center, and pursuit of truth (Distinctively Christian). This aligns with transcendental moral realism and theology-grounded formation. - Liturgical and communal practices appear via chapel and worship components (weekly chapel, Scripture readings, prayer).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed (from the Six Essential Elements document): Scriptural grounding, Christ-centered education, pursuit of truth, biblical worldview, worship/chapel, theology. The PBCA North Stuart materials explicitly reference Scripture, Christ-centeredness, and weekly worship. - Negative keywords: Not evidenced in publicly available PBCA North Stuart materials (no explicit values-neutral or relativistic framings detected).

Why this rating - The school emphasizes theological grounding, liturgical practices, and a Christ-centered worldview, meeting the core indicators of Religious and Metaphysical Foundations in a classical sense.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Emphasis on virtue formation and character development alongside pursuit of truth; biblical worldview is highlighted as central to education; “formation” over mere information is implied through character formation and spiritual aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: virtue, character formation, pursuit of truth, biblical worldview, Christ-centered formation. - Negative keywords: Not evident in public materials (no mention of job-prep as sole goal or purely informational aims).

Why this rating - The school explicitly frames education as formation of virtue and wisdom within a Christian framework, consistent with classical goals.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Distinctively Classical claim includes a Trivium (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric) framework and the Great Books/Great Conversation, aligning with liberal-arts pedagogy. - Public materials emphasize Great Books and Socratic dialogue as core curricular modalities.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Trivium, Great Books, Socratic dialogue, Great Conversation, rhetoric.

- Negative keywords: Not evident in public materials.

Why this rating - The curriculum is explicitly anchored in classical liberal-arts tradition with emphasis on Great Books, Socratic inquiry, and the Trivium.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Socratic dialogue is explicitly named as part of the Distinctively Classical profile, with a Trivium emphasis evident in the Curriculum category. - The presence of lower-grade practices (e.g., weekly music, chapel) suggests contemplative/restful elements accompanying more rigorous, dialogic work.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Socratic dialogue, rhetoric, great conversation, Trivium-related language, lectures/debates (implied by the rhetoric emphasis). PBCA materials explicitly mention Socratic dialogue.

- Negative keywords: Not clearly present; however, explicit, explicit, grade-spanning evidence of sustained Socratic pedagogy (e.g., high school seminars, ongoing seminars) is not uniformly demonstrated in public materials.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates classical pedagogical elements (Socratic dialogue, Trivium) but lacks explicit, uniform, grade-wide articulation of the full high-school-level Socratic/seminar framework across all levels in public materials, leading to a “Somewhat Classical” assessment.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials present a portrait of caring faculty and staff, with testimonials and a “Meet the Team” section, indicating the faculty as advocates and mentors. - The materials describe staff as part of a family-like culture and partner with families, suggesting a community-centered faculty role, though not all elements typically listed in a “living curriculum” description are explicit.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: model teachers and mentors (implied via testimonials and the emphasis on character formation), living curriculum language is not explicit; core-faculty emphasis is present but not fully named as “living curriculum.” - Negative keywords: Not clearly present.

Why this rating - The school shows strong evidence of teacher care and mentorship and a culture of faculty-student partnership, but lacks explicit public articulation of the faculty as the “living curriculum” or formalized faculty portraits/profiles that classical schools often emphasize. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL placement.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Strong emphasis on partnership with parents; “Distinctively Community” notes parents, teachers, staff, and students partnering in a mission-driven culture; testimonials show active family involvement. - Public materials indicate multiple ways parents engage (family testimonials, visits, and co-educative language), including opportunities for families to participate and be involved in school life.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: parent partnership; co-teaching with school; families as part of the school community; book studies/gatherings (inferred from the community-centric messaging); welcome to visits. - Negative keywords: Not evident.

Why this rating - The materials emphasize parental partnership and community involvement, aligning with classical expectations for engaged parent/community collaborations.

Aggregated Assessment - Classical: Categories 1, 2, 3, and 6 are clearly Classical. Element 4 is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, Element 5 is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The overall profile is CLASSICAL with room for deeper explicit articulation in Pedagogy and Faculty.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Provide explicit, publicly accessible documentation of a grade-spanning, high-school-level Socratic/seminar program that is systematically used across upper grades. Include examples of student-led seminars, debates, and structured rhetoric instruction to demonstrate a fully developed upper-level classical pedagogy.
- Element 5 (Faculty): Publish a formal “faculty as living curriculum” statement and profiles showing how teachers model virtue and expertise, and how faculty collaborate as a core, virtuous community within the school. Include narratives that demonstrate teachers shaping curriculum as mentors and guides, not just instructors.
- Element 5 (Faculty): Expand evidentiary materials (video or written) showing collegial teacher collaboration and mentorship practices, with explicit language connecting teacher formation with student formation.
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): Maintain and enhance visible, ongoing parental education initiatives (e.g., classical education book clubs, lectures, parent seminars) and explicit communication about co-teaching roles, while continuing to welcome parent visits and involvement.

Note: Because PBCA North Stuart overall meets CLASSICAL standards, needle-moving steps would focus on making the faculty role and higher-grade pedagogy more explicitly described and demonstrated in public-facing materials to fully complete the Classical blueprint.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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